Example scientific referee report

Heritage-product consumer evaluation · teaching illustration (not an automated software result)

Review decision	Holistic score	Material	Research methods	Verification status
Major revision	**7.0 / 10**	34-page manuscript described in teaching guide	Cross-sectional online survey, **N = 496**; PLS-SEM + fsQCA	**Source-derived narrative; not independently executed or verified**

> **Report purpose.** Demonstrate a useful *presentation format*: concise decision brief, ranked major issues, directly actionable closure tests, a diagnostic scorecard, and a responsible data/reanalysis decision. The source is a teaching guide documenting a prior conversation. It is **not** a new evaluation by the Beihang Referee engine. The underlying manuscript, instrument, data and code are not supplied here. Page and line numbers refer to the 34-page manuscript as reported by the source, and have not been checked against the manuscript.

1. Editorial assessment

The study integrates perceptions of craftsmanship, cultural authenticity and contemporary relevance with cultural-continuity appraisals, affective response and purchase intent. In the supplied teaching account, all three antecedents exhibit positive conditional associations with the cultural-continuity variable. The submission is characterized as **empirical and conceptually incremental**, not a review article.

The central concern is **claim–measurement alignment**, followed by the interpretation of causal/serial paths in cross-sectional data, transparency of fsQCA, moderation reporting, and scale provenance. The teaching case's overall **7.0/10** is a holistic judgment and **not** the arithmetic mean of the dimension ratings or an acceptance probability.

Priority order: (1) establish construct content validity; (2) recover original analysis/scale provenance; (3) remove unsupported causal implications; (4) test sensitivity and resolve reporting gaps; (5) then refine the paper's contribution and presentation.

2. Major concerns — priority and closure

M1 · Construct content does not fully match the PCC label

Reported manuscript anchor: pp. 11 and 29; lines 391–400; Appendix A.
Evidence reported by guide: four items cover historical/cultural memory, continuation of values, cultural meaning, and the value of traditional culture; only one clearly addresses continuity over time.
Why consequential: reliability of a set of responses does not establish that the latent construct

represents *temporal cultural continuity*. The study's central interpretation depends on this meaning.
Minimum resolution: map each exact administered item against the conceptual definition and original source; retain PCC only with defensible item-domain evidence, or consider the explicitly different construct *Perceived Cultural Heritage Significance (PCHS)*.
Closure test: item–definition mapping is documented; definition, hypotheses, figure, tables, results, implications and limitations are consistent with the retained/revised interpretation. An item relabeling alone does not establish content validity.
Status: Open in teaching illustration — data/source-material review not performed.

M2 · Causal mechanisms and serial effects are overinterpreted

Reported anchor: pp. 4–5, 11–12, 21–22.
Evidence reported by guide: product cues are discussed but not experimentally assigned or directly observed, and PLS-SEM paths are estimated from cross-sectional self-reports. Serial standardized indirect estimates are reported as **0.037 (TCA), 0.025 (PCA), 0.040 (PCR)**.
Why consequential: statistical mediation under a chosen ordering does not identify causal mediation or the temporal sequence of appraisals.
Minimum resolution: frame effects as model-conditional associations, describe unmeasured competing mechanisms and causal limits, and reserve mechanistic language for designs that identify the sequence.
Closure test: abstract, hypotheses, discussion, tables and conclusions no longer equate cross-sectional associations with observed causal processes unless independent identification evidence is provided.
Status: Open.

M3 · fsQCA solution cannot be checked from the reported output

Reported anchor: pp. 22–24.
Evidence reported by guide: ten configurations, solution coverage **0.85433** and consistency **0.824604**, with S9–S10 configuration-level consistency given as **NR**; calibration uses standardized anchors **+3 / 0 / −3**.
Why consequential: incomplete configuration reporting and untested calibration/threshold choices prevent readers from evaluating the configurational findings.
Minimum resolution: recover original input, calibration, truth table, necessity, minimization and sensitivity outputs; report all configurations. If reconstruction is impossible, remove unsupported conclusions rather than filling missing values.
Closure test: a reproducible analysis yields all reported measures and reasonable threshold sensitivity, or the unverified analysis is withdrawn.
Status: Open — re-execution not performed.

M4 · Scale provenance and construct specification require inspection

Reported anchor: pp. 8–10, 14, 16–17; reference list p. 32.
Evidence reported by guide: a cited source for the PCR modernity scale appears mismatched to the bibliography; TCA facets may behave as formative rather than interchangeable reflective indicators; TCO mixes several related cultural orientations.
Why consequential: incorrect source attribution and untested measurement specification weaken construct interpretation and any moderation involving those constructs.
Minimum resolution: recover original scale publications and administered wording, publish an adaptation trace, and examine defensible alternative measurement specifications using existing observations.
Closure test: every indicator traces to an authentic source or disclosed new development, and sensitivity

analyses support the final interpretation.
Status: Open — source publications not independently checked.

M5 · Moderation and prediction need fully recoverable reporting

Reported anchor: pp. 13–14, 18–22; lines 653–660 and 733–746.
Evidence reported by guide: PK interactions have reported coefficients **0.220, 0.152 and 0.174**, with small incremental effect sizes; TCO × PCC → PAR is reported as **β = 0.484, f^2 = 0.196**. BI is reported with **Q^2 = 0.074**.
Why consequential: interaction directions alone do not establish robust mechanisms; a positive prediction metric does not demonstrate strong out-of-sample purchase-intent prediction.
Minimum resolution: supply integrated-model estimates, lower-order terms, interactions, confidence intervals, conditional slopes, cross-validation settings and comparable benchmark errors.
Closure test: analysis scripts and tables reproduce reported coefficients, interaction plots and predictive comparisons.
Status: Open.

M6 · Sampling, ethical transparency and presentation consistency

Reported anchor: pp. 15–17, Figure 1 p. 16, discussion p. 24.
Evidence reported by guide: survey reference-object wording varies between one product and product categories, and a figure retains a prior construct label. Recruitment, consent, screening and data-availability documentation require completion.
Why consequential: inconsistent reference objects may create unexplained heterogeneity; mislabeling and incomplete provenance impair verification.
Minimum resolution: describe exact respondent instructions, panel selection, screening, recruitment and dates, complete documented ethics statements, and harmonize labels across all materials.
Closure test: questionnaire/source records and a full-paper terminology audit agree with the updated methods, figures and disclosures.
Status: Open.

3. Twenty-eight-dimension teaching scorecard

The following values were **reported in the source teaching guide**. They are **illustrative expert judgments**, not calibrated probabilities and not outputs generated by Referee in this package.

Dimension	/10	Dimension	/10
Journal scope alignment	8.2	Research significance	7.4
Problem formulation	8.0	Originality of research question	7.1
Theoretical novelty	6.5	Theoretical integration	7.0
Construct clarity	7.2	Construct operationalization	6.4

Dimension	/10	Dimension	/10
Conceptual discriminant validity	7.0	Literature breadth	7.7
Literature critical synthesis	7.0	Hypothesis development	7.4
Mechanistic specificity	**6.0**	Research design	6.8
Sample size and statistical power	8.3	Sampling and generalizability	6.6
Measurement-model reporting	7.8	PLS-SEM analysis	7.3
Moderation analysis	6.7	Serial indirect analysis	6.8
fsQCA rigor and transparency	**5.6**	Predictive validity	6.8
Statistical interpretation	7.7	Robustness and reproducibility	**5.9**
Results presentation	7.1	Discussion and implications	7.3
Writing and presentation quality	7.0	Ethics and research transparency	6.4

Interpretation: the weakest diagnostic areas in the reported scores are **fsQCA transparency (5.6)**, **robustness/reproducibility (5.9)** and **mechanistic specificity (6.0)**. These do not outweigh the content-validity issue merely because a numerical ranking is lower.

4. Construct decision: keep, clarify or rename

Construct	Teaching recommendation	New data immediately?
TCA · Traditional Craftsmanship Appraisal	Retain; test measurement-specification alternatives	No, not for initial sensitivity analysis
PCA · Perceived Cultural Authenticity	Clarify as *respondent-inferred* authenticity	No
PCR · Perceived Contemporary Relevance	Verify scale origin and item adaptation	No

Construct	Teaching recommendation	New data immediately?
PCC · Perceived Cultural Continuity	**Conditional:** consider *Perceived Cultural Heritage Significance* only if theory meaning is revised	Not for reinterpretation alone
PK · Product Knowledge	Clarify as *Subjective Product Knowledge*	No
TCO · Traditional Cultural Orientation	Retain provisionally; examine item/domain heterogeneity	Not initially
PAR · Positive Affective Response	Retain	No
BI · Buying Intent	Retain; do not describe as actual purchasing	No

Renaming is a theory decision, not a find-and-replace operation. Changes must propagate through construct definition → hypotheses → model figure → reported results → implications → limitations. Cronbach’s alpha or HTMT cannot establish content validity.

5. Revision triage: when existing data suffice

Revision route	What to do	Evidence required to close
A · Reporting correction	Align terminology, disclose recruitment, improve tables	Changed text/figure and traceable supporting source
B · Existing-data reanalysis	Alternative measurement models, conditional slopes, fsQCA rerun, predictive checks	Rerunnable scripts, logs and numerical agreement
C · Source audit	Trace scale and bibliographic sources to actual instruments	Original publication, original items, adaptation table
D · Independent content validation	Expert ratings or validation sample for disputed construct meaning	Documented design, ratings and explicit interpretive limits
E · New measurement/design	Test actual preservation, experimentally assigned product cues, factual knowledge or verified purchases	New measures, appropriate design and recorded outcomes

Decision: do **not** collect new respondents just to make the paper appear stronger. First use the existing data to close A–C issues. Collect new data only when the revised claim genuinely requires a property absent from the instrument (such as causal cue effects or real purchases).

6. Scientific integrity and provenance

- **Source:** `source_teaching_guide.pdf`, a 15-page teaching transcript prepared 12 October 2026.
- **Underlying manuscript:** described in the teaching guide, **not included in this repository**; quoted locators are reported rather than independently checked.
- **Beihang Referee runtime: not run on this case**; no actual model, verifier or evidence-gate trace is claimed.
- **Primary source audits:** original questionnaires, cited scale sources, raw records and scripts **not examined** here.
- **Results and scores:** transcribed/summarized from the teaching document; no new computational estimates invented or produced.
- **Editorial recommendation:** an illustrative *major revision* judgment, not a journal decision.

For an actual run with machine-verifiable provenance, follow the root Quickstart and the deterministic offline demo. This report illustrates a *reader-friendly output format*, not the output of a verified model run.